

that users don't understand the meaning of "backing up on the cloud" and aren't used to the idea of a non-local medium of storage. Cloud storage is safe, easy and efficient.

Big players like Google, Microsoft, Amazon and Apple ensure that you're aware of their forays into cloud storage. If anything, the trend is encouraging. And with each of them competing to be the best, the winners are probably the users who are already associated with them. Search giant Google offers Google Drive, which can be installed on a PC or accessed via a web browser. Drive lets you save attachments received in your mailbox. Additionally, any important files can be backed up by manually dropping them in the installed Drive folder. Linux users, on the other hand, are forced to use web browsers to access their files. With small(er) players such as Dropbox entering the picture, users can access their data regardless of which operating system they're on. Backing up has become as easy as dragging and dropping. Apps on your phone allow you to back up and sync photos, videos, music, text files, etc with not more than a touch. Many services prompt you to save your files on the cloud and the only requirement is a valid account and granted permission.

Even computer-savvy individuals have probably experienced some form of data loss or the other over the years. And with data recovery prices being sky high, it's highly recommended that any user label their files (at least in their head) as important or not so important. Data backup is an extremely simple procedure – one that can save you lots of hassle and prevent burning a hole in your pocket.

Why create a data backup? Why not!

Sample this. You live in an arid place, which hasn't seen rain in a century. But, global warming has another idea and floods your place with a down-pour one evening. You lose your research data, that's been painstakingly compiled over three years. Well, that's what you get for not taking preventive measures and relying on the law of chance and probability. This Fast Track aims to educate you how and why, if you use a computer excessively for any official, creative, social or business related work, you must have a contingency strategy.

There are many reasons why people don't take backups. "Nothing will happen to my data" is one of the most common answers that people come up with when confronted about slacking in this area. "Nothing?" Are you sure? If the whole talk about natural disasters wrecking havoc on your